

Trees

Trees in the park in July

Fruits

Red Currants



Currant bush in the woods

Apples



Apple Tree

Nuts



Beech Tree in Dr Jack's

Acorns

2 very small acorns on a stalk and how they'll look in Autumn But what are these acorns?



. English Oak



Turkey Oak

2 oaks in the Nielsen hedge have different leaves and acorns
Turkey Oaks introduced into Britain in 1735 as ornamental trees



BUT THEN DANGER!!



The Turkey Oak supports a species of moth called the gall wasp

Gall wasps can severely damage English Oak acorns

Could they affect the future of England's most iconic tree?

It was thought so

In 1998 the MOD ordered the felling of all Turkey Oaks on its UK bases



Today they're not seen as a threat

In praise of Oaks –

- sacred to many gods including Zeus and Jupiter, both gods of thunder and lightning – oaks being taller and prone to lightning strikes
- they support more wildlife than any other native tree
 - couples used to be married under oaks in Cromwell's time
 - acorns are not produced until tree is at least 40 years old
 - Peak acorn production between 80 and 120 years of age

Trees

More about the oaks in our park later

Horse Chestnuts

The leaves of all 8 of our Horse Chestnuts as well as a few saplings are looking very patchy and autumnal even though we're only just in July. Thanks to Ali for alerting us to the fact that it could be Horse Chestnut leaf blotch or leaf miner.



Horse chestnut leaf blotch is caused by a fungus and looks like irregular brown blotches with yellow margins.



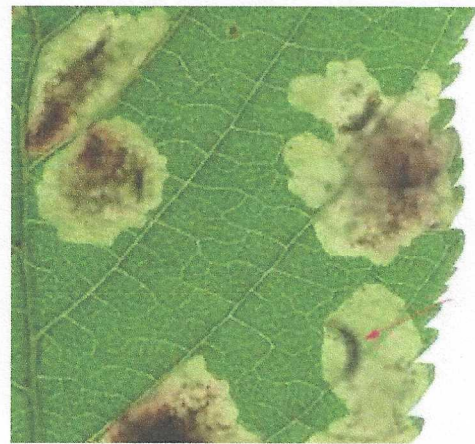
We think our blotchy leaves are caused by the leaf miner moth whose larvae mine within the leaves.



Hold a leaf up to the light and you might see the larvae, caterpillars or grubs whatever you like to call them mining and munching away inside the leaf.

Eventually the leaves die and drop off but new ones grow (and get infected).

They cause significant damage, as we can see, to the appearance of the trees but there is no evidence that the damage by the moth leads to tree death. However photosynthetic storage in the leaves may be reduced.



Treatment

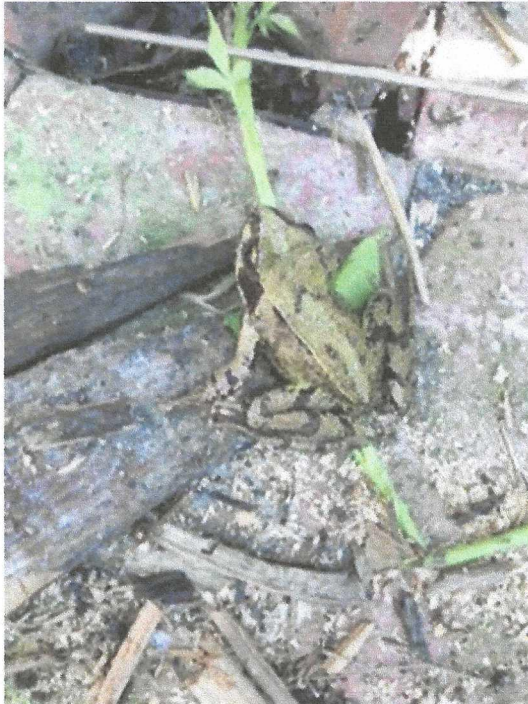


Great and blue tits eat the larvae so encourage them? They only cope with a tiny percentage though.

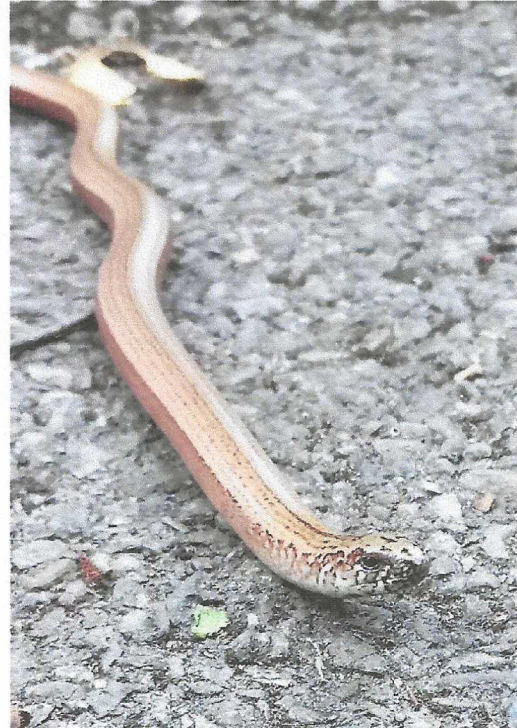
Collecting fallen leaves and burning, or covering with soil to kill overwintering pupae.

And Other Things

Amphibian – Frog There's one in
The garage behind the pavilion



Reptile – a Slow worm snapped by Barry
nearby in CS Lewis Reserve



Insects



Black & Yellow Long Horn
found in the
woodland hedge



Damselfly

And ? Anyone know what
this beetle is?
Found on one of the lime
trees on the Nielsen hedge

